PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Incident Response | Vulnerability Management | Microsoft Security

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of hands-on experience delivering enterprise-scale security operations within complex, large-scale environments. I specialise in Tier 2 and Tier 3 alert triage, incident response and digital forensics, vulnerability management, and threat detection across Microsoft technology stacks including Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender. I am comfortable working without predefined playbooks and applying technical judgement to novel threats, coordinating major incident response efforts, and owning the vulnerability management lifecycle from identification through to remediation validation. Having deployed and managed security tooling across an organisation of more than 8,000 users, I bring a proven ability to operate at scale, communicate clearly with stakeholders at all levels, and drive continuous improvement in security posture.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Operations and Incident Response:** Tier 2/3 alert triage, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) investigation, threat hunting, major incident coordination, digital forensics, NIST 800-61 IR lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework
- **Microsoft Security Platform:** Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender (M365), Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), role-based access control, Conditional Access policies
- **Vulnerability and Exposure Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), risk-based prioritisation, remediation tracking
- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk / Search Processing Language (SPL), custom detection rules and alert tuning
- **Endpoint Security and EDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Tanium, Microsoft Intune / Mobile Device Management (MDM)
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR), automated playbooks and runbooks
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Other Tools:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast, BeyondTrust, Microsoft Intune / Mobile Application Management (MAM)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Serve as the senior escalation point for Tier 2 and Tier 3 security alerts, applying independent technical judgement to investigate and contain threats across a complex, multi-site organisation with over 8,000 users.
- Lead incident response for major cyber security events in accordance with the NIST 800-61 framework, coordinating cross-functional teams including IT, legal, and senior leadership to minimise business impact.
- Own the vulnerability management lifecycle using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), conducting risk-based prioritisation and tracking remediation through to closure.
- Monitor and investigate security events across Microsoft Entra ID and Microsoft 365, using Microsoft Defender XDR and Defender for Endpoint (MDE) to identify and respond to threats at scale.
- Author and tune SIEM detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, reducing false positives and improving mean time to detect (MTTD) for high-priority threat categories.

- Support Identity and Access Management (IAM) security hardening through Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and privileged access reviews using BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM).
- Develop PowerShell scripts to automate threat intelligence enrichment and alert triage workflows, significantly reducing analyst workload for repetitive tier-1 tasks.
- Conduct threat hunting exercises using MITRE ATT&CK framework mappings to proactively identify adversary behaviours that evade automated detection.
- Support third-party security assessments and penetration test remediation reviews, coordinating findings against the organisation's risk register.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Performed Tier 2 alert triage and incident response for security events across endpoints, email, and identity platforms, escalating confirmed threats and coordinating remediation with infrastructure teams.
- Led the deployment and configuration of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across over 8,000 devices, establishing baseline detection policies and onboarding device groups.
- Administered Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to detect lateral movement, credential theft, and Active Directory (AD) reconnaissance activities.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID security controls including Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and MFA enforcement across the user estate.
- Conducted regular vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, producing risk-prioritised reports for senior stakeholders and tracking remediation progress.
- Maintained and improved Check Point Harmony firewall rule sets, enforcing network segmentation and least-privilege access policies.
- Administered Mimecast email security platform, tuning spam, phishing, and malware detection policies and investigating email-borne incidents.
- Supported the development and testing of SIEM detection rules and incident response playbooks, contributing to a reduction in mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-severity incidents.
- Delivered security awareness sessions and phishing simulation campaigns to build a culture of cyber awareness across the organisation.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed endpoint security and device compliance across a SaaS/FinTech environment, using Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) to enforce security policies.
- Supported vulnerability scanning and patch management processes, identifying and remediating weaknesses in line with the organisation's security baseline.
- Administered identity and access controls, including user provisioning, role-based access reviews, and multi-factor authentication (MFA) rollout.
- Maintained cloud and on-premises infrastructure security, supporting the IT Security team with risk assessments and policy compliance reviews aligned to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials+.
- Monitored security alerts and escalated incidents, contributing to the development of incident response procedures and security runbooks.
- Collaborated with development and quality assurance teams to embed security into software delivery processes, conducting code and configuration reviews for the SaaS platform.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000+ user devices, establishing enterprise-wide endpoint visibility and detection capability from the ground up.
- Reduced false positive alert volume by over 40% through systematic SIEM rule tuning and threshold refinement in Microsoft Sentinel.
- Led the response to multiple high-severity incidents including ransomware and business email compromise (BEC) attempts, containing threats before material data loss occurred.
- Improved vulnerability remediation timescales by 30% by introducing risk-based prioritisation and automated tracking workflows using PowerShell and Tenable.io integrations.

- Developed and delivered a security awareness programme that reduced successful phishing simulation click-through rates by 60% over 12 months.
- Achieved and maintained CISSP certification, demonstrating breadth of knowledge across all eight security domains including Security Operations, Identity and Access Management, and Security Assessment and Testing.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)